

JAGDISH NV



NURTURING: Infosys's unique campus programmes build talent

multi-disciplinary engineering colleges across India. Says managing director Anand Mahindra: "The idea of Mahindra College of Engineering has arisen out of a need for higher order of people. We will use technology to solve the problem of scalability and the curriculum will have ample liberal arts too as we want to develop people with right and left brain skills."

Low-cost airline SpiceJet has joined hands with the University of Petroleum and Energy Studies to provide its employees full-time MBA and BBA programme in aviation management. The fully-sponsored programme will be the second major human resource initiative after ESOPs for all employees. The programme will enable junior and middle-level managers to develop skills required for higher managerial positions. Explains Siddhanta Sharma, executive chairman & CEO, SpiceJet: "Our people are our most valued assets and we believe in investing in them for their individual growth and the development of the company."

Going a step further and looking beyond its employees, Infosys has

initiated a programme 'Campus Connect' to improve the employability of graduates passing out of colleges in rural and semi-urban areas. The company helps develop special programmes and courses that go a long way in personality development. It is working with 1,200 colleges, that include 400 engineering colleges in Karnataka and Maharashtra. Says Mohandas Pai of Infosys: "In Dharwad, we could earlier hire 3 per cent of a batch; now the employability is up to 23 per cent."

Along with investing in creating a pool of talent, companies are also focusing on right skilling so that over-qualified employees are not made to do jobs which do not require their kind of skills. The IT sector has taken the lead in this, given its high human capital cost. For instance, at Infosys 20 per cent of the jobs, which were earlier done by engineers, are now done by graduates from general disciplines.

For high growth sectors like retail and agri-services, which are just about taking off in India, companies are looking at creating a talent pool across the board. For instance, the Future

5 ways to retain talent

High attrition rates force firms to give sops with ESOPs

- 1 Sign-on bonus**
58.7 per cent of companies use it for their top management
- 2 Retention bonus**
is a tool used by 40.8 per cent companies for middle management
- 3 Stock options**
33.3 per cent of employers apply it on their top management
- 4 Skill-based bonuses**
18.4 per cent of companies use this to retain middle management
- 5 Overseas assignments**
58.5 per cent of companies practise it for their supervisory level

Source: Watson Wyatt survey

Group has tied up with the Welingkar Institute for courses in retail management. This apart, professional players like Teamlease Services too are entering the fray with partnerships. TeamLease has tied up with Manipal University to launch a two-month programme in retail. The residential programme will initially run in Bangalore and tier-II towns of Karnataka. The course will cost Rs 13,000 and will come with a job guarantee.

Clearly, corporates seem to have realised that rather than complain and whine about wage inflation, it's time they learnt to live with new management principles like attrition agnostic work places and right skilling. ■

66.3% companies have reward strategy for superior performance.